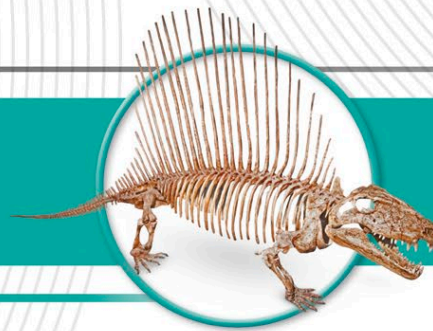


GLOSSARY



ABELISAURID

A type of large, meat-eating theropod. Abelisaurids thrived during the Cretaceous Period.

ADAPTATION

A special feature of an organism that makes it better suited to its environment.

AIR SAC

A little growth of tissue filled with air. Air sacs help a creature breathe and keep its body light.

AMBER

Sticky tree resin that has become hard and tough over many millions of years.

AMBUSH

A surprise attack by a predator on an unsuspecting prey.

AMMONITE

A marine mollusk with a coiled shell and octopuslike tentacles that was common in the Mesozoic Era.

ANATOMY

A branch of science involving the study of the physical structure and internal workings of all living things.

ANKYLOSAUR

A type of ornithischian (bird-hipped) dinosaur. Ankylosaurs were armored plant eaters with a body covered in bony plates.

ARCHOSAUR

One of a group of reptiles that includes the dinosaurs, pterosaurs, and the extinct relatives of crocodiles and alligators, as well as modern-day birds and crocodylians.

ARTHROPOD

An invertebrate with a segmented body and a hard outer covering called an exoskeleton. Living examples of arthropods include insects and spiders.

ASTEROID

A large, rocky object that orbits the Sun. Asteroids are bigger than meteors but smaller than dwarf planets.

BONE BED

A massive deposit of fossil bones.

BROODING

Adult animals keeping eggs or hatchlings warm by covering them with their feathered bodies or wings.

CARBONIFEROUS

The fifth period of the Paleozoic Era. It began 358 million years ago and ended 298 million years ago.

CENOZOIC

The era that followed the Mesozoic. It started 66 million years ago and continues in the present day.

CERATOPSIAN

A type of ornithischian (bird-hipped) dinosaur. Ceratopsians were plant eaters with horns on the head or bony frills around the skull.

COPROLITE

Fossilized animal droppings, which often contain fragments of undigested food.

CRETACEOUS

The third period of the Mesozoic Era. It began 145 million years ago and ended 66 million years ago.

CROCODYLIAN

A group of reptiles that includes modern-day crocodiles and alligators as well as extinct relatives, such as *Deinosuchus*.

CT SCANNER

A machine that takes detailed pictures of the insides of a creature's body or of its parts.

DENTAL BATTERY

An arrangement of small, interlocking teeth in some plant-eating dinosaurs that help grind up tough plant matter.

DICRAEOSAURID

A type of small, short-necked sauropod. Dicraeosaurids lived in the span of time between the Early Jurassic and Cretaceous periods.

DIGITS

The fingers or toes of limbed vertebrates.

DISPLAY

In animals, a demonstration of fitness or strength, usually to frighten off a rival or to attract a mate.

ECOSYSTEM

A community or collection of living organisms that interact with each other and with their surrounding environment in a particular way.

ENAMEL

The hard outer layer on the teeth of most animals that makes the teeth resistant to wear and tear.

ERA

A span of geological time that defines a phase of the history of life, such as the Paleozoic or Mesozoic. Each era is made up of periods.

EUKARYOTE

An organism made out of a complex cell or cells containing nuclei and other structures that are enclosed in membranes. All animals, plants, and fungi are eukaryotes.

FILTER FEEDER

An animal that feeds by straining shrimp, algae, or other small organisms out of the water.

FRILL

A bony, platelike extension around the neck of certain animals.

HABITAT

The natural home environment of an animal or plant.

HADROSAUR

A type of ornithomimid with a complex set of teeth, called a dental battery, and a ducklike beak.

HATCHLING

A newly hatched baby animal.

HETERODONT

An animal with two or more differently shaped sets of teeth in its jaws, such as sharp teeth for biting and cheek teeth for chewing food.

ICHTHYOSAUR

A type of dolphinlike marine reptile that was common for much of the Mesozoic Era.

INCUBATE

To keep eggs warm so they develop and hatch.

IRIDIUM

A type of chemical element that is more abundant in asteroids, meteors, and other space rocks than on Earth.

KERATIN

A tough substance found in the hair, feathers, scales, claws, and horns of most animals.

LARVA

The young form of an insect that looks different from its parents and often eats different food.

LIGAMENTS

Strong, slightly elastic, cordlike structures in an animal's body that attach bones to each other.

MAMMAL

One of a group of warm-blooded, often hairy vertebrates that feed their young on milk supplied by the mother.